BLUETREAD · ACCESSIBILITY SERVICES

Accessibility, in plain terms

Accessibility means everyone can use your website or app, including people who are blind, deaf, have low vision or can't use a mouse. About 1 in 4 U.S. adults has a disability (CDC).

Why

Complaints and lawsuits

Thousands of U.S. accessibility lawsuits are filed every year. An audit shows where you stand.

New legal deadlines

ADA Title II (Apr 2027–28): state and local governments, public universities, special districts. **EU Accessibility Act** (2025): businesses selling to EU consumers. **Section 508**: federal agencies and vendors.

Contracts and RFPs

Buyers ask for a VPAT or proof of WCAG AA before they sign.

A better product

Clear, accessible design means fewer support tickets and more completed checkouts.

A, AA and AAA: what the levels mean

Criteria come from **WCAG 2.2**, the W3C's web standard: **86 pass/fail criteria** in three levels, each including the levels below it.

Level A

Can people use it at all?

The bare minimum (31 criteria).

- Works with a keyboard alone
- Images have text descriptions
- Videos have captions

Effort: lowest (code fixes).
Return: removes blockers; rarely enough alone for legal or contract needs.

Level AA — Recommended

Can people use it comfortably?

What laws and contracts cite (24 more).

- Text has enough contrast to read
- Works when zoomed to 200%
- Keyboard focus is always visible

Added effort: moderate (design and front-end, done with A).
Return: meets laws and contracts; the biggest drop in legal risk.

Level AAA

Is it the best it can be?

The highest level (31 more criteria).

- Stronger contrast (7:1)
- Sign language for video
- Plain language, no time limits

Added effort: high, ongoing (content, media, brand colors).
Return: diminishing site-wide (the W3C doesn't advise it); worth it for key flows in healthcare, government, education.

How we score your product

1 Scan

Automated tools and scripts check every page of your product.

2 Test by hand

Tools catch 30–40% of issues, so we also test with screen readers.

3 Verify and rate

Every issue is confirmed, mapped to WCAG and rated.

4 Score

Start at 100, subtract points per issue.

What you get from an audit

SCORE
71 / 100
Not yet conformant

1	2	3	6
Critical	High	Medium	Low

Critical — **Checkout can't be completed with a keyboard**
WCAG 2.1.1 · checkout

High — **Form errors aren't announced to screen readers**
WCAG 3.3.1, 4.1.3 · sign-up

Points per issue

SEVERITY	POINTS	MEANS
Critical	−10	Blocks a key task
High	−5	Major barrier
Medium	−2	Has a workaround
Low	−0.5	Minor annoyance

Scaled to your product's size. The score tracks progress; conformance means zero failures.

Common questions

Can't we just use a plugin?
Plugins and scanners catch only 30–40% of issues. We add hands-on keyboard and screen reader testing.

Do you fix issues, or just find them?
Both. You get developer-ready tickets and a phased plan; we fix or support your team, then re-test.

What do you need from us?
Your key pages or sitemap, test accounts for each user role, staging access, and code access.

Not sure where you stand? Start with a short discovery call to scope your audit.